



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tall Oaks Academy

School Website: <https://www.talloaksacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Tall Oaks Academy in Kenosha, WI (53142) presents a clearly classical Christian orientation across public-facing materials. The school consistently foregrounds a distinctly Christian and classical approach to education, integrates liturgical elements and a community ethos, emphasizes formation and virtue alongside knowledge, and explicitly references liberal arts foundations, Great Books, and Paideia-inspired ideas. The public materials demonstrate alignment with the six elements of classical schooling, particularly in religious/metaphysical foundations, school purpose and goal, and curriculum. There is strong evidence of communal and parental partnership, as well as a robust pride in a living, mentorship-rich faculty model. Pedagogical practices show elements of memory-work, reverence for tradition, and a mix of Socratic-inflected dialogue and memory-based methods, though high-school-level Socratic seminars may be less overtly documented in the site's public materials. Overall, Tall Oaks Academy leans toward CLASSICAL, with some areas that appear more clearly CLASSICAL than others (notably curriculum and parish/parent partnership). The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials repeatedly present a explicitly Christian mission and theology-grounded framing: "Partnering with Christian parents to raise up children in the nurture and admonition of the Lord" and "distinctly Christian and distinctively classical" positioning. - The school's statements of faith and biblical foundation are foregrounded, with references to Bible-based learning and a Christian worldview in admissions and mission content. - Liturgical/communal practices are indicated (daily chapel, hymn singing, prayer, etc.). - The site notes the Word of God as a foundational axis ("the Word of God is the firm Foundation of this school").

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Christianity, biblical worldview, theology, liturgy/church-related terms, Word of God, Statements of Faith, chapel, worship, Christian mission, imago Dei (theological anthropology). About 6–9 distinct positives appear in public materials. - Negative keywords: Essentially none in evidence (no religiously neutral or secular emphasis detected on the front-facing pages).

Why this rating - The public materials explicitly anchor education in Christian/theological foundations and liturgical/community practices, meeting the transcendental moral realism, theology grounding, and liturgical/community criteria of Element 1. The combination of mission language, theology-forward statements, and chapel-worship integration strongly supports CLASSICAL (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) for Tall Oaks.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation and virtue as core aims, not merely job preparation, with language about life preparation and forming the soul. One prominent articulation: “Our aim is much higher than just preparing students for a job. We want to prepare them for life.” - The mission frames education as formation (formation of character and affections) and explicitly connects to the liberal arts tradition, with references to partnering with Christian parents toward human flourishing in a classical mold. - There is explicit reference to “Great Books/Great Conversation” and Paideia-inspired aims in public materials, signaling a purpose oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, paideia, great conversation, truth/goodness/beauty, telos, classical mission, contemplation/scholé. - Negative keywords present: minimal; the site’s framing is not focused on job/workforce readiness in its primary mission language, though job-readiness is not aggressively foregrounded.

Why this rating - Tall Oaks’ stated aims and framing center formation and the search for truth, goodness, and beauty in a liberal-arts context, rather than narrow job-prep. The explicit emphasis on life-oriented outcomes and a classical mission aligns with CLASSICAL in School Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Lower School outlines explicit engagement with the seven liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as foundational, with a clear grammar-stage emphasis, Latin, grammar, literature, and other liberal-arts subjects. - The site presents a strong Great Books/“Great Conversation” orientation (e.g., references to Great Books and Foundation Series, Paideia) as core curricular elements. - Texts and readings described across content show a commitment to primary/“living” texts, classical literature, and integrated study across disciplines (history, literature, philosophy, sciences) with cross-curricular connections and wonder. - Preschool and early grades emphasize the liberal-arts approach, memory, recitation, and habit development (grammar-related learning through singing and memorization; Latin and classical content introduced early).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Quadrivium, Great Books, primary sources, classical canon, Western civilization, interconnection/harmony of subjects, wonder, formation through the arts. - Negative keywords present: There is little sign of social-studies replacement or a purely modernized, non-textual approach on the site.

Why this rating - The curriculum language and content align closely with classical education expectations: explicit Seven Liberal Arts and Quadrivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, integrated/harmonized subjects, and a clear emphasis on wonder and formation through classical texts. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 3.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower school pedagogy includes memory work, recitation, repetition, and habit formation, with an emphasis on “developing habits of success” and active, imitation-based learning in the grammar stage. - There are explicit references to contemplative/restful learning (Scholé-like elements) and a balanced pace in early grades; the site includes language around reverence and wonder in learning, which aligns with scholé concepts. - Paideia/Great Books-oriented content and references to Socratic-style dialogue appear in the public materials (foundation discussions, articles, and Paideia-related content). This suggests some up-level pedagogy (Socratic/seminar-style) in upper grades, though explicit public references to high-school seminars are less consistently documented on the site.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé, memory work, recitation, chanting (in some classical pedagogy), memory-based learning, Socratic/dialogue (in materials discussing classical pedagogy), seminars, rhetoric, debate, and moral formation. - Negative keywords present: project-based learning emphasis and experiential-only approaches are not predominant on the site; the site does not foreground a strictly constructivist or exclusively student-led project-based approach as the core pedagogy.

Why this rating - The public materials clearly embrace memory-based, recitation-centered elements and a pace that invites contemplation, with Socratic-like inquiry referenced in classical pedagogy discussions. However, explicit, consistent documentation of full high-school-level Socratic seminars and a pervasive seminar-based upper-school pedagogy is not as strongly evidenced as the other categories. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL classification for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and site language emphasize staff dedication, high-quality teachers, and a culture of virtues and mentorship. The site highlights “the staff, faculty, and leadership” and the idea of forming a strong, caring educational community. - The site frequently frames teachers as practitioners who model virtue and as essential parts of the culture (distinctly Christian/classical framing; living example of the educational aims). There are references to the staff’s role in “the culture” and to the Head of School, as well as the presence of a board and school leadership. - The site discusses community and parental partnership as integral to the school’s living-curriculum approach, implying a collaborative faculty-community dynamic.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentor/teacher as model, teacher as exemplar, faculty of friends, leadership by example, virtuous teaching, professional teachers, mentorship. - Negative keywords: none clearly evident on the public pages; however, explicit phrases like “certification-driven” or “facilitator-on-the-side” (which would signal a divergence) are not present.

Why this rating - The materials show a strong emphasis on faculty as moral exemplars and living curriculum, but the public materials do not always provide granular evidence of a fully developed faculty model (e.g., explicit portraits of teacher roles, long-form faculty professional development in classical pedagogy). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s mission explicitly centers parental partnership: “Partnering with Christian parents to raise up children in the nurture and admonition of the Lord,” and the site positions parents as co-educators and primary participants in the educational mission. - There is explicit emphasis on educating parents through the website, articles, and book-club/gatherings about classical education (parent formation content referenced in public posts and parent resources). - The campus messaging invites parental involvement (open house, tours, frequent parent nights) and a welcoming stance for visits, reflecting a highly engaged parent community posture. Examples include open house events, and a tour invitation, with contact details and parent-facing resources.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school partnership, parent involvement, open campus, hospitality, family formation, classical parent training, parental responsibility, parent-teacher collaboration. - Negative keywords present: none evident; there is no strong consumer-only language or minimal parent involvement.

Why this rating - Tall Oaks publicly frames parents as essential co-educators and actively promotes parental formation and open engagement with the school community. This aligns strongly with the Parents & Community criteria of CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- The school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, and Parents & Community with strong, explicit evidence.
- Pedagogy is clearly aligned with classical methods but qualitative documentation of high-school-level Socratic seminars is less explicit, resulting in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.
- Faculty evidence supports a classical orientation but is not as explicitly detailed as other categories, yielding SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Overall, Tall Oaks Academy demonstrates CLASSICAL orientation with strong fidelity to classical/Christian education tenets, and it presents a coherent classical-Christian program across its public-facing materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- Provide explicit, public detailing of high-school-level Socratic seminars and seminars-based upper-level pedagogy, including examples of student-led Socratic dialogues, debates, and rhetoric training. This would strengthen Element 4 to CLASSICAL.
- Include explicit faculty portraits or a short “living curriculum” narrative that demonstrates teachers as daily exemplars and mentors in the classroom, addressing possible gaps in Element 5.
- Expand parent-facing curricular resources that document structured, ongoing parent formation programs (book studies, seminars, and family-liturgical practices) to deepen the CLASSICAL alignment in Element 6.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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